

HIRU: 13 Years Into Building a Maasai Action Game

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HIRU has spent 13 years moving from an idea toward an African action game. Kunta Content founder Dean Gichukie says he [wrote its story in 2013](#), although active development only began in 2020. The Nairobi studio's game follows a young Maasai prince hunting poachers who killed his clan, kidnapped his sister, and threatened his land. A [trailer published in August 2025](#)

showed the planned savannas, forests, and deserts. Kunta describes HIRU as a 3D action-adventure set in an African mythological world and lists [PC and consoles](#), but gives no release date. That matters because a 2022 report expected the game in 2023.

The schedule reflects its funding model. Gichukie said in 2023 that Kunta was largely self-funding HIRU and taking other projects to keep development moving. The studio also used training, accelerator support, Ubisoft prototype funding, and the ID@Xbox program. By 2024, it reported expanding a 100 m² test map into a 4 km by 4 km world with 4K visuals. That is progress, but a trailer and technical targets are not a finished game. Kunta has not published a playable demo or firm launch window. What exists today is a Nairobi team building an African setting for the PC and console audience served by far better-funded studios.

Sources:

- [Kunta Content games](#)
- [Games Industry Africa trailer report](#)
- [Safaricom on HIRU's development](#)
- [PreMortem Games interview with Dean Gichukie](#)
- [Kenyans.co.ke's 2022 report](#)

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